

Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἀφροδισιεύς

Alexander of Aphrodisias on Peripatetic Domestic Life

eul_aid: ree

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Μικτὰὶ διάλεκτοι [Mixed Dialects \(frg\)](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Peripatetic](#)

Alexander of Aphrodisias was a Greek philosopher who lived and worked in the late second and early third centuries CE. He originated from the city of Aphrodisias in Asia Minor but moved to Athens, where he held the state-funded chair in Peripatetic philosophy. This appointment is dated to between 198 and 209 CE. He is best known as the most important ancient commentator on the works of Aristotle, earning him the epithet "the commentator."

His extensive writings include detailed commentaries on Aristotle's *Prior Analytics*, *Topics*, *Meteorology*, and *Metaphysics*, among other texts. He also authored independent philosophical treatises. Key surviving works include *On Fate*, a major defense of free will against Stoic determinism, and *On the Soul*, which explores Aristotle's theory of mind. Some works traditionally attributed to him are considered spurious by modern scholars.

Alexander of Aphrodisias played a crucial role in the history of philosophy by reviving and systematizing Aristotelian thought while actively defending it against rival schools like Stoicism. His interpretations became the standard authority for later Greek, Arabic, and medieval Latin philosophers. His arguments concerning fate, the soul, and the nature of intellect were foundational and remained widely debated for centuries after his death.

Works (2)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Σατυρικοῦ Δράματος · [Fragments on a Satyr Play](#) · 4 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Οἰκιακοῦ Βίου · [Fragments on Domestic Life](#) · 9 passages

Other Peripatetic Authors

- Ἀγαθαρχίδης ὁ Κνίδιος · [Agatharchides of Cnidus](#) · 4 works
- Ἀνδρόνικος ὁ Ῥόδιος · [Andronicus of Rhodes](#) · 2 works
- Ἀρίστων ὁ Κεῖος · [Aristo of Ceos](#) · 1 work
- Ἀριστόβουλος ὁ Ἰουδαῖος · [Aristobulus the Jewish Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- Ἀριστοκλῆς ὁ Μεσσηνίος · [Aristocles of Messene](#) · 1 work
- Ἀριστόμβροτος ὁ φιλόσοφος · [Aristombrotus the Philosopher](#) · 1 work
- Ἀρίστων ὁ Κεῖος · [Ariston of Ceos](#) · 1 work

- Ἀσπάσιος ὁ Περιπατητικός · [Aspasius the Peripatetic](#) · 1 work
- Βοηθὸς ὁ Σιδώνιος · [Boethus of Sidon](#) · 1 work
- Χαμαιλέων ὁ Ἡρακλεώτης · [Chamaeleon of Heraclea Pontica](#) · 2 works
- Κλέαρχος ὁ Σολεύς · [Clearchus of Soli](#) · 1 work
- Κριτόλαος ὁ Φασηλίτης · [Critolaus of Phaselis philosopher](#) · 1 work